

Ministry of Forests, Lands and Natural Resource Operations

BC River Forecast Centre

UPDATE- Flood Warning: Peace Region and tributaries of Williston Lake

Issued: 25June2011 12:30 PM

The BC River Forecast Centre is **upgrading** the advisory to a **Flood Warning** for:

- Peace Region
- Tributaries of Williston Lake

A low pressure trough is working its way across British Columbia, and has stalled over the south Peace Region. Rainfall rates over the past 48 hours in the areas around Fort St. John and west have been in the 40-150mm range, with the highest rates around Hudson's Hope and the eastern slopes of the Rocky Mountains from Pine Pass north to the Sikanni Chief River.

Environment Canada has maintained a rainfall warning for the Peace and Williston regions, with additional rainfall amounts of 10-40mm expected through Saturday.

River levels in the region have been rising rapidly over the past 24 hours. Current levels on gauged rivers are:

- Sikanni Chief River near Fort Nelson (10CB001) is at 410 m³/s. This is approximately a 10-year flow level
- Carbon Creek (07EF004) west of Hudson's Hope is at approximately 250 m³/s and is continuing to rise. This is currently the flood of record on Carbon Creek (12 years of monitoring)
- Halfway River (07FA006) is at 1300 m³/s and rising at 3 cm/hour. This is approaching a 10-year flow level
- Moberly River (07FB008) is at 120 m³/s and rising at 2.5 cm/hour. This is a 20-year flow level
- Pine River (07FB001) is at 1700 m³/s and rising at 8 cm/hour. This is at a 5-year flow level

The current river response is largely due to heavy rainfall from late-Thursday into Friday. With additional heavy rainfall over Friday, and more expected through Saturday, significant additional rises in river levels is expected through Sunday, and into Monday for larger river systems. Flooding is expected throughout the region, and some rivers may reach record level.

Specific rivers of concern include the Sikanni Chief River, Halfway River, Beatton River, Carbon Creek, Pine River, Moberly River and Kiskatinaw River, and all smaller tributary rivers within the area.

The River Forecast Centre will continue to monitor conditions and will provide an update as conditions warrant. Current streamflow information is available from the River Forecast Centre website: <http://bcrfc.env.gov.bc.ca/>.

A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.